

YouTube Ad Specs Guide: Formats, Sizes & Requirements 2026

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YouTube ad specs are the technical and design requirements your video or creative assets must meet to run ads on YouTube through Google Ads. Following these specifications ensures your ads are approved, display correctly across devices, and deliver the best performance.

Key YouTube ad specifications include 1080p resolution, recommended aspect ratios (16:9 horizontal, 9:16 vertical, and 1:1 square), supported video formats like MPEG-2 or MPEG-4, and a maximum file size of 256 GB. Meeting these requirements helps prevent ad rejections, improves viewing experience, and ensures your ads reach the right audience effectively.

In this guide, we explain the complete YouTube ad specs for different ad formats, including video ads, display assets, and other creatives used in YouTube campaigns.

TL;DR: YouTube Ad Specs At A Glance

Ad Format	Length	Aspect Ratio	Max File Size	Resolution (Recommended)	Headline
Skippable In-Stream	Any; 15–20s (Awareness/Action); 2–3 mins (Consideration)	16:9, 9:16, 1:1	256 GB	1920×1080 (H), 1080×1920 (V), 1080×1080 (sq)	≤15 chars
Non-Skippable In-Stream	7–15s (standard); up to 30s (CTV only)	16:9, 9:16, 1:1	256 GB	1920×1080 (H), 1080×1920 (V), 1080×1080 (sq)	≤15 chars
Bumper Ads	≤6s (hard limit)	16:9, 9:16, 1:1	1 GB	1920×1080 (H), 1080×1920 (V), 1080×1080 (sq)	≤15 chars
In-Feed Video	Any; 15–20s recommended	16:9, 9:16, 1:1	256 GB	1920×1080 (H), 1080×1920 (V), 1080×1080 (sq)	40 chars (2 lines)
YouTube Shorts Ads	≤3 mins; ≤60s recommended; 10–30s (action); 10–60s (PMax/VRC)	9:16 (recommended), 1:1, 16:9 (accepted)	—	1080×1920px	—
Audio Ads	≤30s; ≤15s = non-skippable; 16–30s = skippable	16:9	128 GB	240p to 2160p	—
Pause Ads	Static image	4:5.5 to 4:4 (avoid extremes)	2 MB	Width/Height: 1080–1350px	≤70 chars
Masthead	≤30s autoplay (desktop); full duration (mobile & TV)	16:9	—	1920×1080 or higher	Use the Preview Tool
Companion Banner	—	300×60px	150 KB	300×60px	—
Demand Gen – Image	—	1.91:1 (H), 1:1 (sq), 4:5 (V), 9:16 (Shorts)	5 MB per image	1200×628 (H), 1200×1200 (sq), 960×1200 (V), 1080×1920 (9:16)	40 chars (up to 5)
Demand Gen – Carousel	—	1.91:1 (H), 1:1 (sq), 4:5 (V)	5 MB per image	1200×628 (H), 1200×1200 (sq), 960×1200 (V)	40 chars

Ad Format	Length	Aspect Ratio	Max File Size	Resolution (Recommended)	Headline
Demand Gen – Video	≥5s; <10s won't serve in-stream; 15s+ recommended	16:9, 1:1, 4:5, 9:16	256 GB	1920×1080 (H), 1080×1080 (sq), 1080×1350 (4:5), 1080×1920 (9:16)	40 chars (headline), 90 chars (long headline)
Video View Campaigns (VVC)	In-stream/In-feed: ≥:05; Shorts: :10–:60	16:9, 9:16, 1:1	256 GB	1920×1080 (H), 1080×1920 (V), 1080×1080 (sq)	—
Video Reach Campaigns (VRC)	Efficient reach: :06–:15; Non-skip: :07–:30; Target freq: :06–:15	16:9, 9:16, 1:1	256 GB	1920×1080 (H), 1080×1920 (V), 1080×1080 (sq)	90 chars
PMax – Video	≥10s	16:9, 1:1, 9:16	—	1920×1080 (H), 1080×1920 (V), 1080×1080 (sq)	—
Display (Responsive)	≤30s	16:9, 1:1, 2:3	—	1200×628 (H), 600×600 (sq)	30 chars (1–5 headlines)

Universal video specs across all formats: Recommended resolution 1920×1080px (1080p Full HD) · Recommended format MP4/MPG · Max file size ≤256 GB (video ads).

YouTube Ad Safe Zones

Ad Type	Resolution	Top Margin	Bottom Margin	Left Margin	Right Margin
Vertical Video Ads (Mobile & Tablet)	1080×1920px	288px	672px	48px	192px
Horizontal Video Ads (Mobile)	1920×1080px	38px	387px	496px	162px

Types of YouTube Ads

Here's a quick overview of the different types of YouTube ads you can see or run for your business:

- **Video Ads:** These include skippable in-stream, non-skippable in-stream, bumper, in-feed, and YouTube Shorts ads.
- **Non-Video Ads:** Display ads, companion banners, overlay ads (deprecated by Google), audio ads, pause ads, and masthead ads.
- **Campaign-Type Ads:** Demand Gen, Video View Campaigns, Video Reach Campaigns, Performance Max (PMax), and DV360.

YouTube In-Stream Ad Specs

In-stream ads play before, during, or after a video on YouTube and across Google video partner sites. These are of two main types: skippable and non-skippable.

Skippable In-Stream Ad Specs

Skippable in-stream ads give you the option to skip after 5 seconds, which also makes them one of the most used YouTube ad formats. They can be run across different types of devices, such as desktop, mobile, and TV, and support a range of campaign goals, ranging from sales to brand awareness.

Available Assets	YouTube video URL, Final URL, Display URL, and Companion Banner.
Resolution	Recommended: 1080p (Full HD) – 1920×1080px (H), 1080×1920px (V), 1080×1080px (sq). 720p (Standard HD) also accepted. Minimum: 1280×720px (H), 720×1280px (V), 480×480px (sq).
Aspect Ratio	16:9 (horizontal), 9:16 (vertical), 1:1 (square).
Format	MP4, MPG, MOV, AVI, WMV, FLV, WebM, 3GPP, ProRes, HEVC (h265), and more.
Max File Size	≤256 GB.
Length	No minimum or maximum. Recommended by objective – Awareness: :15–:20; Consideration: 2:00–3:00; Action: :15–:20.
Ad Copy Specs	Headlines: ≤15 characters. CTAs (if used): ≤10 characters.

Non-Skippable In-Stream Ad Specs

Non-skippable in-stream ads play before, during, or after a video, and they don't have an option to skip. This ensures that you can easily deliver the entire message to your target audience. For these ads, you can use three formats: bumper ads, standard non-skippable ads, and 30-second non-skippable ads (CTV).

Available Assets	YouTube video URL, Final URL, Display URL, and Companion Banner.
Resolution	Recommended: 1080p (Full HD) – 1920×1080px (H), 1080×1920px (V), 1080×1080px (sq). 720p (Standard HD) also accepted. Minimum: 1280×720px (H), 720×1280px (V), 480×480px (sq).
Aspect Ratio	16:9 (horizontal), 9:16 (vertical), 1:1 (square). 30-second videos must always be horizontal.
Format	MP4, MPG, MOV, AVI, WMV, FLV, WebM, 3GPP, ProRes, HEVC (h265), and more.
File Size	Maximum 256 GB.
Length	Recommended: :15, or :30 for Connected TV (CTV). Also acceptable: :07–:15, :16–:30.
Ad Copy Specs	Headlines: max 15 characters. CTAs: max 10 characters.

YouTube Companion Banner Specs

A companion banner is a static image that appears alongside your video ads on the YouTube watch page. When a user clicks on it, they reach the website URL you provided while creating the campaign. Companion banners only appear with skippable in-stream, non-skippable in-stream, and bumper ads.

Resolution	300×60px
File Formats	JPEG, GIF, PNG
Max File Size	150 KB
GIF Frame Rate	Fewer than 5 frames per second

Devices	Desktop only
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YouTube Bumper Ads Specs

Bumper ads are non-skippable videos that enable you to extend your campaign's reach by appearing before the viewer's chosen video. Their length is just 6 seconds, and they are specifically designed for brand recall.

Resolution	Recommended: 1920×1080px (H), 1080×1920px (V), 1080×1080px (sq). Minimum: 1280×720px (H), 720×1280px (V), 480×480px (sq).
Aspect Ratio	16:9 (horizontal), 9:16 (vertical), 1:1 (square).
File Formats	MP4, MPG, MOV, AVI, WMV, FLV, WebM, 3GPP, ProRes, HEVC (h265), and more.
File Size	Max 1 GB.
Ad Copy Specs	Headlines: max 15 characters. CTAs: max 10 characters.
Companion Banner	300×60px — JPEG, GIF, or PNG — max 150 KB.
Bidding	Target CPM only.

YouTube In-Feed Ad Specs

In-feed video ads enable you to promote your brand, products, or services alongside YouTube content that your target audience is likely to view. These ads appear in YouTube search results, YouTube watch next, and the YouTube app Home feed.

Resolution	Recommended: 1920×1080px (H), 1080×1920px (V), 1080×1080px (sq). Minimum: 1280×720px (H), 720×1280px (V), 480×480px (sq).
Aspect Ratio	Recommended: 16:9 (horizontal), 1:1 (square). Also usable: 4:3 (SD, horizontal), 9:16 (vertical), 2:3 (SD, vertical).
Format	Recommended: MPG (MPEG-2 or MPEG-4). Also usable: WMV, AVI, MOV, FLV, MPEG-1, MP4, MPEGPS, etc.
File Size	Should not exceed 256 GB.
Length	No specific restrictions. Google recommends 15–20 seconds for awareness, 2–3 seconds for consideration.
Ad Copy Specs	Headlines: up to 2 lines, 40 characters per line. Descriptions: up to 2 lines, 35 characters per line.

YouTube Shorts Ads Specs

YouTube Shorts ads are vertical, full-screen video ads that appear between organic videos in the Shorts feed. They are designed for mobile-first viewing and tend to work effectively against the awareness and consideration ad campaign objectives.

Video Assets	Vertical (recommended). Square and portrait static image assets are also eligible for Demand Gen campaigns, but the background must be enhanced.
Aspect Ratio	9:16 (vertical) is recommended.
Ad Length	Up to 3 minutes, recommended under 60 seconds. Action-oriented: 10–30s vertical. Video reach campaigns: 10–60s. Video action/app/PMax campaigns: 10–60s.
Ad Copy Specs	Uses the advertiser's channel name and description. Descriptions limited to 2 lines of 35 characters.
CTA Button Appears	3 seconds into the ad (PMax, App, Demand Gen); 10 seconds into the ad (Video View, Video Reach).

YouTube Audio Ad Specs

YouTube audio ads allow you to reach your target audience when they are listening to music, podcasts, or other audio content on YouTube. They are most helpful when your goal is to expand your reach and increase brand awareness.

Required Asset File	A link to your YouTube video (the video must be uploaded to YouTube).
Ad Length & Serving	Maximum 30 seconds. Up to 15 seconds serves as non-skippable; 16–30 seconds serves as skippable.
File Size	Max 128 GB.
Resolution	426×240 (240p), 640×360 (360p), 854×480 (480p), 1280×720 (720p), 1920×1080 (1080p), 2560×1440 (1440p), 3840×2160 (2160p).
Aspect Ratio	16:9. If 4:3 is used, black bars are automatically added to the sides.
Sound	Use assets with light animation or static images with a CTA.
Audio Tone	Be friendly and conversational.
Bidding	Target CPM.

YouTube Pause Ad Specs

YouTube pause ads are a display ad format that appear as static images 10 seconds after a viewer pauses a video, alongside the pause screen. They are non-intrusive, helping deliver your message without affecting user experience. Currently available only on Connected TV devices in select countries such as the US, UK, and Spain.

Available Assets	Long headlines or taglines; Final URL (should align with what you are promoting).
Recommended Dimensions	Width: 1080–1350px; Height: 1080–1350px.
Aspect Ratio	Between 4:5.5 and 4:4. Avoid extreme ratios.
File Formats	PNG or JPG.
File Size	Maximum 2 MB.
Transparency	Supported and recommended, to blend with the CTV background.
Ad Copy Specs	Maximum 70 characters, compliant with Google's text policies. Ad name max 255 characters.
Reference Video ID	Must link to a unique, publicly available video not used in other campaigns.

YouTube Masthead Ad Specs

YouTube Masthead ads enable you to showcase your brand, product, or service in a native video-based ad format that appears to users in the YouTube Home feed across all devices. Ideal for driving massive awareness or marketing your brand prominently across YouTube's Home feed.

YouTube Video URL	Link to your video. Can be any standard uploaded video, but must be "Public" or "Unlisted" to be eligible to serve.
Resolution & Aspect Ratio	Recommended: 16:9 for optimal performance. Resolution: 1920×1080 or higher.
Headline	Appears next to, on, or under the Masthead. Use the Masthead Preview Tool for exact length limits.
Call-to-Action Text	Use the Masthead Preview Tool for length recommendations.
Supporting Description	Optional. Use the Masthead Preview Tool for length and other requirements.
Primary Video Layout	Select either "Widescreen" or "Standard video size."
Companion Videos	Optional. If added, include 2 unique videos.

YouTube Video View Campaign (VVC) Ad Specs

Video View Campaigns use Google AI and serve multi-format ads across skippable in-stream, in-feed, and YouTube Shorts placements to automatically find where your ads will best perform. These campaigns operate on the Target cost-per-view (CPV) bidding strategy.

Resolution	Recommended: 1080p (Full HD) – 1920×1080px (H), 1080×1920px (V), 1080×1080px (sq). 720p also accepted. Minimum: 1280×720px (H), 720×1280px (V), 480×480px (sq).
Aspect Ratio	16:9 (horizontal), 9:16 (vertical), 1:1 (square).
Format	MP4, MPG, MOV, AVI, WMV, FLV, WebM, 3GPP, ProRes, HEVC (h265), and more.
Max File Size	≤256 GB.
Format Composition	Recommended: at least one horizontal :60–3:00, one horizontal :15, and one vertical :10–:60. Skippable in-stream can use ≥:05 horizontal; in-feed can use ≥:05. Google recommends using both vertical and horizontal to fit the right surface.

Video Reach Campaigns (VRC) Ad Specs

Video Reach Campaigns optimize for maximum unique reach across Bumper, Skippable in-stream, non-skippable, in-feed, and YouTube Shorts formats from a single campaign.

Resolution	Recommended: 1920×1080px (H), 1080×1920px (V), 1080×1080px (sq). Minimum: 1280×720px (H), 720×1280px (V), 480×480px (sq).
Aspect Ratio	16:9, 9:16, 1:1. For standard definition: 4:3 (horizontal), 2:3 (vertical).
Format	MP4, MPG, MOV, AVI, WMV, FLV, WebM, 3GPP, ProRes, HEVC (h265), MPEGPS, and CineForm.
Max File Size	≤256 GB.
Non-Skippable Reach Composition	Recommended: one horizontal :15, one horizontal :30, one horizontal :06. 30-second assets must be horizontal. Also accepted: 15s ads :07–:15, 30s CTV ads :16–:30, bumpers ≤:06.
Target Frequency Composition	Recommended: one horizontal :15, one horizontal :06. Also accepted: skippable in-stream any length horizontal, non-skippable reach :07–:15 horizontal, bumper ≤:06 horizontal.

Demand Gen YouTube Ad Specs

Demand Gen ad campaigns help you capture engagement and action across Google's most visually-engaging and immersive surfaces. Using these ads, you can reach up to 3 billion monthly active users while they scroll through their feeds across Google surfaces and discover new products and brands. These ads can appear across YouTube inventory as well as Gmail, Discover, and more.

Single Image

Image	Horizontal 1.91:1: min 600×314, recommended 1200×628. Square 1:1: min 300×300, recommended 1200×1200. Vertical 4:5 (optional): min 480×600, recommended 960×1200.
Ad Copy Specs	Up to 5 headlines, 40 characters max each. Up to 5 descriptions, 90 characters max each. 1 business name required, max 25 characters.

Carousel

Card Level (Images)	2–10 images. Horizontal 1.91:1 (recommended 1200×628). Square 1:1 (recommended 1200×1200). Vertical 4:5 (recommended 960×1200). Square logo: up to 5, dimensions 1:1, max file size 150 KB.
Ad Copy Specs	Headlines: maximum 40 characters. Business name: maximum 25 characters.

Video

Videos	Upload 1–5 videos. Length: min 5 seconds, max depends on placement. Horizontal 16:9 (1920×1080 HD). Square 1:1 (1080×1080 HD). Vertical 4:5 (1080×1350 HD).
Ad Copy Specs	Headline: max 40 characters. Long headline: max 90 characters. Description: max 90 characters. CTA: max 10 characters.

PMax YouTube Ad Specs

Performance Max is a goal-based campaign type you can use to market your brand, products, and services across the entire Google Ads inventory (including YouTube) from a single campaign. PMax campaigns are mostly powered by Google AI, though you can provide inputs through search themes, audience signals, audience lists, and more.

Images

Horizontal 1.91:1	1200×628 recommended; add more than 4 images. Max file size 5,120 KB.
Square 1:1	1200×1200 recommended; add more than 4 images. Max file size 5,120 KB.
Vertical 4:5	960×1200 recommended; Google recommends more than 2 images.

Videos

Horizontal 16:9	At least 10 seconds. Recommended: 1 video for each orientation.
Square 1:1	At least 10 seconds. Recommended: 1 video for each orientation.
Vertical 9:16	At least 10 seconds. Recommended: 1 video for each orientation.

Display YouTube Ad Specs

Google Display ad campaigns use responsive display ads, which leverage Google AI to combine your provided assets — images, videos, and more — into optimized formats for any ad space. This saves time and effort versus creating ads manually, and extends your reach across Google surfaces such as YouTube and Gmail.

Text	Headlines: 30 characters max, ideally 1–5 used. Long headlines: 90 characters max, ideally 1 used. Descriptions: 90 characters max, ideally 1–5 used.
Images	Horizontal (1.91:1): recommended 1200×628px, use 5 ideally. Logo (1:1): recommended 1200×1200px, use 1. Square (1:1): recommended 600×600px, use 5 ideally.
Videos	Horizontal (16:9): 2 videos of 30 seconds. Square (1:1): 2 videos of 30 seconds. Vertical (2:3): 2 videos of 30 seconds.

Bonus: YouTube Safe Zones for Ads

Safe zones define where you should place critical elements — logos, CTAs, etc. — in the ad creative to avoid them getting cropped by YouTube UI elements. These differ by placement, device, and campaign type.

Vertical video ads (1080×1920) on mobile devices	Leave free of content: 288px from the top, 192px from the right, 48px from the left, 672px from the bottom.
Horizontal video ads (1920×1080)	Leave free of content: 162px from the right, 38px from the top, 387px from the bottom.

Which YouTube Ad Specs Format Should You Use?

The decision table below helps advertisers quickly identify which YouTube ad format works best for specific campaign goals.

Goal	Recommended Format	Why
Brand awareness (broad)	Bumper Ads + Non-Skippable	Non-skippable ensures full message delivery; bumpers reinforce at scale
Drive website traffic / conversions	Skippable In-Stream	Pay only when users watch 30s+ or click; strong CTA options
Product consideration	In-Feed Video Ads	Appears where users are actively browsing; self-selected views
Mobile / Shorts-native audiences	YouTube Shorts Ads	Full-screen vertical; native to mobile browsing behavior
Re-engage known audiences	Demand Gen (video)	Targets existing signals across YouTube + Gmail + Discover
Massive launch / high-impact moment	Masthead Ad	Guaranteed homepage placement; requires Google rep booking
Podcast / audio content reach	Audio Ads	Reaches users in audio-only sessions; unique format
All goals from one campaign	Performance Max	Google AI optimizes across all formats automatically

Conclusion

Getting your YouTube ad specs right is the foundation of every successful campaign — wrong dimensions, formats, or safe zone violations can mean rejected creatives, poor display quality, or wasted spend before a single viewer sees your ad.

Use this guide as your go-to reference across every format, from skippable in-stream to Demand Gen and Masthead, and always preview your creatives across devices before launch.

Good luck.

FAQs

Is 1080p or 720p better for YouTube ads?

Google recommends using 1080p (Full HD) as it looks much sharper across all types of devices. Although Google supports 720p videos as well, their quality isn't as good as full HD video files.

What are the requirements to get ads on YouTube?

There are several key requirements, such as having a Google Ads account, a video uploaded to YouTube (public or unlisted), a final URL, and assets that comply with Google's specifications and policy requirements.

What are some YouTube ad copy character limits?

YouTube ad copy character limits vary by the format you are using. For example, skippable and non-skippable in-stream ads limit headlines to 15 characters, while pause ads allow up to 70 characters.

What are some key YouTube Shorts ads specs?

Use 9:16 (vertical) format videos. For action-oriented ads, the length should be 10–30 seconds; for PMax, 10–60 seconds. For descriptions, you can use 2 lines with 35 characters max each.

What are the Display & Video 360 requirements for YouTube ads?

DV360 YouTube ad specs are mostly identical to those in Google Ads. The key difference is that DV360 enables reserved/programmatic guaranteed deals for premium placements, such as Masthead, as well.